who appointed two fathers and two mothers to superintend and inspect the work, the diet, and the lodging of the prisoners; and to chastise the disobedient.

The workroom was a large room upstairs, separated by a wooden balustrade from the passage (six feet wide) into which spectators were admitted. This room was divided by balustrades into two, for distinguishing those who had suffered some public or corporal punishment, from others who had not been whipped, and exposed on a scaffold. The mother was seated at a desk (where she had a full view of her family at work) with a Bible before her. As I stayed longer than a common visitant, one of the prisoners went up to the mistress with the timid modesty of a suppliant, and asked leave to offer me the plate. The leave was granted. The mistress kept what was given, till it amounted to a sum sufficient to purchase a little tea or coffee, for all to partake.

The kitchen, the dining- and lodging-rooms, were on the ground-floor. In each of the three bedrooms were ten wooden cases, with a straw mattress, two coverlets, sheets, and one large pillow, for two persons. All were clean, and showed the attention of the regents.

In this house you might see a number of criminals (in 1776 there were thirty-two; in 1778, forty-six; in June 1781, thirty-two, and in November, forty), some of whom had been the most abandoned, sitting in presence of the mother, quiet and orderly at their different sorts of work; spinning, plain work, etc. Of the latter sort much was sent in from the city. They had the same holidays as at the rasp-house. Hours of work from six to twelve, and from one to eight. I saw them go from work to dinner:[1] the keeper, or father as they called him, presided. First they sang a psalm: then they went in order down to a neat dining-room; where they seated themselves at two tables; and several dishes of boiled barley, agreeably sweetened, were set before them. The father struck with a hammer: then in profound silence all stood up; and one of them read with propriety a prayer about four or five minutes.

[1] The diet of the prisoners was as follows:
Sunday. Dinner: Cut-cabbage with meat. Supper: Buttermilk.
Monday. Dinner: White beans. Supper: Sweet milk with barley.
Tuesday. Dinner: Beans. Supper: Buttermilk.
Wednesday. Dinner: Grey peas. Supper: Buttermilk.
Thursday. Dinner: Barley. Supper: Bread and beer.
Friday. Dinner: White beans. Supper: Buttermilk.
Saturday. Dinner: Beans. Supper: Buttermilk.

Then they sat down cheerful; and each filled her bowl, from a large dish which contained enough for four of them. Then one brought on a waiter slices of bread and butter, and served each prisoner.

This house was supported by a small annual tax on those who sell tobacco, beer, and other liquors, and one-fourth part of what was received at public exhibitions and diversions.

At my visit in June 1783, the prisoners were all removed into the new workhouse.

Here (as at some other towns in Holland) was a prison or workhouse for slighter offences. This was called the old rasp-house, and was worthy of observation, as a well regulated house of industry. Here were confined beggars and vagabonds, who for the first time were committed for six weeks, and for the second three months; but for the third their punishment was either a longer period of confinement or banishment. Drunkards also were here confined, and such as were guilty of petty larceny. In a large room at one of my visits I saw forty-six women carding, spinning, and reeling; twelve weaving coarse linen or sail-cloth; thirteen making and mending linen; one employed in keeping the room clean; and the mother holding a slate, on which were inscribed the names of the prisoners.[1] Some men and boys were in another large room, in which there were many looms. But most of the men were at work in the courts, boiling and picking oakum for calking the seams of ships. Among these men I counted forty or fifty women; and in 1781, there were twenty-five men and one hundred and twenty women all employed in the same manner;[2] except five or six who were mending the linen of the house.

The women's bedroom was spacious; and I found it clean and in order, though I was there before ten o'clock in the forenoon.

This house was provided with (what seems to be much wanted in the Dutch prisons) an infirmary: but it was too small and close for the purpose.

The diet of the prisoners was the same as in the spin-house.[3]

[1] Three fathers and three mothers were appointed to superintend this house. One father had the direction of the house-keeping, and the other two overlooked the manufactory. One mother managed the kitchen; and the office of the others was to keep the prisoners cleanly, and to take care of their bedding.

[2] The prisoners at the new workhouse have the same employment: here is a quick sale for oakum; for the Admiralty and India Company find the old cords, and take the oakum when fit for use.

[3] Though in the houses of correction in Holland, the prisoners have meat only on Sundays, yet the peas, beans, barley, etc., are always made into a kind of thick soup or pottage, which is very palatable, and is served up hot at noon.